

AI FOR QA TESTERS

AI Hallucination Checklist

Spot confident-but-false AI output before it reaches your testing.

Introduction

A hallucination is plausible, confident output that is actually false — invented requirements, fields, functions or results. This checklist helps you catch them.

Detection Checklist

- Does the output cite a rule, field or function I can confirm exists?
- Have I checked specifics against the real spec / app / docs?
- Are there overly confident claims with no source?
- Does any "requirement" appear that no one actually stated?
- Is the test data actually valid for the real system?
- If I cannot verify a specific, have I flagged or removed it?

Worked Example

AI states an API returns a "discountCode" field. You check the real API — no such field exists. You remove the hallucinated detail rather than build a useless test around it.

Practical Exercise

Ask AI about a system you know well and deliberately look for one inaccuracy. Note how confidently it presented the wrong detail.

Best Practices

- Verify against the source, not against how good the text sounds.
- Be most sceptical of precise specifics.
- Never let hallucinated rules into your test basis.

Common Mistakes

- Trusting fluent output as accurate.
- Skipping verification under time pressure.
- Treating AI as a source of truth.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

Hallucinations are most dangerous when they are plausible. The more important the detail, the harder you verify it.